



Ending a Situationship

Using no contact to move on from something that was never defined

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A situationship (more than friends, never quite a relationship) can be harder to get over than a "real" breakup. There's no clear ending, no shared language for what you lost, and often a lot of hope that never had a chance to be tested. Yes, no contact still applies. It might matter even more.

Why situationships hurt so much

- Ambiguity: without clear labels, your mind keeps trying to work out what it was.
- Unmet hope: you grieve what it could have become, not just what it was.
- Intermittent attention: warm one week, distant the next, a pattern that's very hard to let go of.
- Less support: friends may not treat it as a "real" breakup, so you grieve alone.

Your grief is valid

How much something hurts isn't decided by its label. If you were invested, you're allowed to grieve it properly: talk about it, write about it, give it time.

How to end it (if it's not already over)

You don't need a long conversation. A short, clear message is enough: "I've realised I want something more defined than this, so I'm going to step back. I wish you well." Then start no contact.

No contact for situationships

- Mute them and archive the chat. Late-night "u up?" messages are the biggest risk.
- Don't reply to breadcrumbs: likes, reactions or vague check-ins.
- Decide in advance what you'll do if they reach out.
- Write down what you actually want in a relationship, so the next person gets measured against that.

Use it to learn what you want

Situationships often show you exactly what you don't want: uncertainty, crumbs, waiting. Write your list of needs and dealbreakers while it's fresh. It's one of the most useful things you can take from the experience.

YOUR NOTES

What I'm taking from this guide

NEXT STEP

Put it into practice for 30 days.

The No-Contact Journal is a printable 30-day guided journal: 90 prompts, a daily no-contact check-in, and a "Before you text them" page for the moments you're about to reach out.

Get it at digitaldisconnect.shop

Or start free with the 3-day starter at digitaldisconnect.shop/free

This guide is general self-help information, not therapy, medical or legal advice. If you're thinking about harming yourself, in the US call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or contact your local emergency number.

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